✦ THE HYMN ✦

The Song of the First Stars

The original hymn, in English

At the beginning of time, there was only her divine mind,
Before her fingertips wrote time into existence,
She sat in nowhereness within the oneness of herself and pondered,
She contemplated what was and what ought to be, and what ought never be,
She studied the nature of her own divine light, and her absence as shadow
And with her knowledge of flawless symmetry she imbued her essence into the empty non-universe,
Her luminous mind then brought forth existence with a point of light,
The first star arose and was itself the first to hear her divine cadence, her music, her voice
And the mother of light sang to the first star of the cosmos,
The first star shone with transcendent resplendence and echoed her song of the first stars,
The cosmic mother, the first light who birthed stars, was pleased to hear her song as a chorus,
One by one, star by star, further points of shimmering light were brought forth into existence,
Each star was born to repeatedly sing a musical note in her divine melody,
And where she sang before, instead she wielded her cosmic veena, a divine instrument,
Each pluck of her tool was a transcendent splendor which ascended the heat of the listening stars,
Her unending concert was the center of the universe, as all of existence was born to hear her play,
Her name was synonymous with music itself, in every language that arose,
Even the civilizations that did not pray to her knew of her existence by implication and rhythm,
Could a more artistic truth be the underlying cause of existence?
The philosophers of the great worlds with their attuned ears still debate, to this day,
But they do so as they tap their feet in accordance with the notes plucked on her divine veena,
Even the greatest theologians and priests and thinkers of the faraway worlds lose themselves to music,
And so it was, and so it is, and so it shall be,
Liraasa, the song of the first stars, by the first mother, for the first children, who listened and learned to speak

Liraasa de li Vanisan Lirayo

Liraasa de li una-ne veluri · in the sacred register

1 En li lombiasa, po miyo doli saivo de mavoasa,
2 kroti saivo de finiri sarbisia li krono ala li pagoasa.
3 Saivo po semnesia nuna-pago, intra saivo de yanoasa, ata po pensapa.
4 Saivo po pensapa ki-coda po miyo, ata ki-coda suvi miyo, ata ki-coda suvi miyo nuna-krono.
5 Saivo po lemula li modoasa de li lumiasa, ata saivo de lumina gase li sadoasa.
6 Ata saivo po lurvala saivo de simvoasa ala li fulenasan pagona yuta li veraasa de li narvonasan lordi.
7 Krotiata saivo de lumisan mavoasa po farlafa li pagoasa yuta baba patu de lumi.
8 Li una-ne velu po navunia, ata ito po ka li una-ne leninela raho po lenila saivo de lumiasasan kronosonbu, saivo de meloasa, saivo de vallaasa.
9 Ata li mareasa de li lumi po lirala ala li una-ne velu de li vemiasa.
10 Li una-ne velu po veluva en tranaasasan lumisirmo, ata po ralera saivo de liraasa.
11 Li mareasa de li vemiasa ka li una-ne lumi raho po kronobioka li veluri; saivo po ke lavisan kube saivo lenila saivo de liraasa gase baba yanolira.
12 Ata rada-krono, baba loterosan patu de sizosan lumi po gome farlafa ala li pagoasa.
13 Rada velu po kronobioka kopisa sahi lirala baba melosan sonbu en saivo de lumiasasan melonulu.
14 Ata kroti ola, saivo po lirala; korsi, saivo po bitiba saivo de vemiasasan veena raho ka baba lumiasasan melobiti.
15 Rada dalu de li melotibi po ke baba tranaasasan lumisirmo raho po lumrala li suma de li veluri raho lenila.
16 Saivo de rinbaasasan melo po ka li cemnuasa, kasa toda li pagoasa po kronobioka kopisa lenila saivo de meloasa.
17 Saivo de nole po ka sambasan ko li melo, en toda lermi raho po keleka.
18 Yesta li mavopagori raho po ne lavbula ala saivo, po sabesia saivo yuta lideodonu ata kronosonbu.
19 Baba kasi lardasan vera nosi ka li vorduasa de li pagoasa ki?
20 En li mellisan vemiri, li lideoserbuyori raho tovota yebasan felberi, loki senoralkasia eli-krono.
21 Nara saivori senoralkasia nayo saivori dumdoda saivori de peburi gase li sonburi raho saivo daluda su saivo de lumiasasan veena.
22 En li vemiri vofa maivori, yesta li mosa sirmosan sabeyori de li devo ata li luminelari ata li pensayori momvima saivori sela en li melo.
23 Ata ola po ka vera, ata ola ka vera, ata ola futu ka vera.
24 Liraasa, li lira de li una-ne veluri, da li una-ne mareasa, vobi li una-ne linuri raho po lenila ata po lemula sidu senosia.

✦ INTERLINEAR ✦

Line by line

Liraasa above, English beneath; highlighted words and ideas do not translate exactly (numbers refer to the notes)

no Liraasa word: paraphrased · approximate or shifted shade · not carried over

1 En li lombiasa, po miyo doli saivo de mavoasa[1],
At the beginning of time[2], there was only her divine mind[1],

2 kroti saivo de finiri[3] sarbisia li krono ala li pagoasa.
Before her fingertips[3] wrote time into existence,

3 Saivo po semnesia nuna-pago[4], intra saivo de yanoasa, ata po pensapa.
She sat in nowhereness[4] within the oneness of herself[5] and pondered,

4 Saivo po pensapa ki-coda po miyo[6], ata ki-coda suvi miyo, ata ki-coda suvi miyo nuna-krono.
She contemplated what was[6] and what ought to be, and what ought never be,

5 Saivo po lemula li modoasa de li lumiasa, ata saivo de lumina[7] gase li sadoasa.
She studied the nature of her own divine light, and her absence[7] as shadow

6 Ata saivo po lurvala[8] saivo de simvoasa[9] ala li fulenasan pagona yuta li veraasa de li narvonasan lordi[10].
And with her knowledge of flawless symmetry[10] she imbued[8] her essence[9] into the empty non-universe,

7 Krotiata saivo de lumisan mavoasa po farlafa li pagoasa yuta baba patu[11] de lumi.
Her luminous mind then brought forth existence with a point[11] of light,

8 Li una-ne velu po navunia, ata ito po ka li una-ne leninela raho po lenila saivo de lumiasasan kronosonbu[12], saivo de meloasa, saivo de vallaasa.
The first star arose and was itself[13] the first to hear her divine cadence[12], her music, her voice

9 Ata li mareasa de li lumi po lirala ala li una-ne velu de li vemiasa.
And the mother of light sang to the first star of the cosmos,

10 Li una-ne velu po veluva en tranaasasan lumisirmo[14], ata po ralera saivo de liraasa.
The first star shone with transcendent resplendence[14] and echoed her song of the first stars,

11 Li mareasa de li vemiasa ka li una-ne lumi raho po kronobioka li veluri;[15] saivo po ke lavisan kube saivo lenila saivo de liraasa gase baba yanolira.
The cosmic mother, the first light who birthed stars,[15] was pleased to hear her song as a chorus,

12 Ata rada-krono, baba loterosan[16] patu de sizosan lumi po gome farlafa ala li pagoasa.
One by one, star by star, further[16] points of shimmering light were brought forth into existence,

13 Rada velu po kronobioka kopisa sahi[17] lirala baba melosan sonbu[18] en saivo de lumiasasan melonulu.
Each star was born to repeatedly[17] sing a musical note[18] in her divine melody,

14 Ata kroti ola, saivo po lirala; korsi, saivo po bitiba[19] saivo de vemiasasan veena[20] raho ka baba lumiasasan melobiti.
And where she sang before, instead she wielded[19] her cosmic veena[20], a divine instrument,

15 Rada dalu de li melotibi[21] po ke baba tranaasasan lumisirmo[14] raho po lumrala li suma[22] de li veluri raho lenila.
Each pluck of her tool[21] was a transcendent splendor[14] which ascended the heat[22] of the listening stars,

16 Saivo de rinbaasasan melo[23] po ka li cemnuasa, kasa[24] toda li pagoasa po kronobioka kopisa lenila saivo de meloasa[23].
Her unending concert[23] was the center of the universe, as[24] all of existence was born to hear her play[23],

17 Saivo de nole po ka sambasan ko[25] li melo, en toda lermi raho po keleka.
Her name was synonymous with[25] music itself[13], in every language that arose,

18 Yesta li mavopagori[26] raho po ne lavbula ala saivo, po sabesia saivo[27] yuta lideodonu[28] ata kronosonbu.
Even the civilizations[26] that did not pray to her knew of her existence[27] by implication[28] and rhythm,

19 Baba kasi lardasan vera nosi ka li vorduasa de li pagoasa ki?
Could a more artistic truth be the underlying cause of existence?

20 En li mellisan vemiri, li lideoserbuyori[29] raho tovota yebasan[30] felberi, loki senoralkasia[31] eli-krono[32].
The philosophers[29] of the great worlds with their attuned[30] ears still debate[31], to this day[32],

21 Nara saivori senoralkasia nayo saivori dumdoda[33] saivori de peburi gase[34] li sonburi raho saivo daluda[21] su saivo de lumiasasan veena.
But they do so as they tap[33] their feet in accordance with[34] the notes plucked[21] on her divine veena,

22 En li vemiri vofa maivori, yesta li mosa sirmosan[35] sabeyori de li devo[36] ata li luminelari ata li pensayori[29] momvima saivori sela en li melo[37].
Even the greatest[35] theologians[36] and priests and thinkers[29] of the faraway worlds lose themselves to music[37],

23 Ata ola po ka vera, ata ola ka vera, ata ola futu ka vera.[38]
And so it was, and so it is, and so it shall be,[38]

24 Liraasa, li lira de li una-ne veluri, da[39] li una-ne mareasa, vobi li una-ne linuri raho po lenila ata po lemula sidu senosia.
Liraasa, the song of the first stars, by[39] the first mother, for the first children, who listened and learned to speak

✦ NOTES ✦

Translator's notes

What could not be carried across, and how each gap was bridged

Register. The hymn is rendered in the sacred register: wherever the lexicon has an ascended form with the right meaning it is used (~mavoasa~ the Universal Mind, ~lombiasa~ genesis, ~lumiasa~ Her Divine Light, ~meloasa~ Divine Music, ~vallaasa~ the voice of creation, ~veraasa~ Divine Knowledge, ~cemnuasa~ the centre of all things, ~vorduasa~ the first cause, ~vemiasa~ the living cosmos). Ascended forms were never forced where their fixed meaning drifts: ~mavopagoasa~ means Heaven, not "civilization".

Grammar. Every word was checked against the 2.5 lexicon and every operator sequence against the twenty-slot order. Two features of the English could not be kept as such: apposition (line 11) and the liturgical "so it was" (line 23). Two words are built by productive rule rather than listed (note 29), one is a copied foreign word (note 20), and one possible typing slip is flagged (note 22).

	ENGLISH	LIRAASA	KIND	RENDERING AND REASON
1	*divine mind*	mavoasa	Approximate	"The Universal Mind, the Grand Soul." Sacred ascended form; broader than a personal "mind": it is *the* Mind.
2	*beginning of time*	lombiasa	Approximate	"Genesis; the beginning of all things." Chosen over kronoasa, which means both the beginning *and* the end of time and would blur the line.
3	*fingertips*	finiri	No word	No word for "tip": rendered "her fingers".
4	*nowhereness*	nuna-pago	Approximate	No noun "nowhereness". The correlative nuna-pago is an adverb: "she sat *nowhere*". (pagona, non-existence, is saved for the "non-universe" of line 6.)
5	*of herself*	—	Not carried	"Within the oneness of herself" becomes intra saivo de yanoasa, "within her oneness". The emphatic "herself" has no settled form: emphatic sela is an open question in 2.5. Note that yanoasa also means "the unity of all things".
6	*what was / what ought to be*	ki-coda … miyo	Approximate	Rendered as embedded questions: "she thought about what there was, what there should be, what there should never be". miyo (there is) with the ki-word as its noun phrase is a reading of the rules, not an attested pattern; "contemplated" becomes pensapa, to think.
7	*her absence*	saivo de lumina	Approximate	"Her lightlessness": lumina = without light. The English "absence" is general; Liraasa can only say what is absent, so it names her absence *as* light's absence, which the line implies. "As shadow" becomes gase li sadoasa, "like the primeval shadow". Also: lumiasa already means *Her* Divine Light, so "her own" is carried by the word itself.
8	*imbued*	lurvala	No word	No verb "imbue": lurvala, to pour.
9	*essence*	simvoasa	Approximate	No word for "essence": simvoasa, "the true self".
10	*symmetry*	lordi	No word	No word for symmetry: li narvonasan lordi, "the flawless order". narvonasan (without darkness; saintly; flawless) carries a holy undertone the English lacks. "Her knowledge" is rendered li veraasa (Divine Knowledge) without "her", because saivo de veraasa de … would chain two des and make the order the owner.
11	*point*	patu	No word	No word for "point" (as in a dot): baba patu de lumi, "a piece of light".
12	*cadence*	kronosonbu	Approximate	"Rhythm." Cadence (a melodic close, a lilt) has no word.
13	*itself*	—	Not carried	Emphatic "itself" is not translated: emphatic sela is undecided in 2.5 (it appears twice: lines 8 and 17).
14	*resplendence · splendor*	lumisirmo	No word	No word for splendour or resplendence: lumisirmo, "glory" (light + renown), used in both lines 10 and 15.
15	*appositive phrase*	… ka …;	Approximate	Liraasa has no ruled apposition, so "The cosmic mother, the first light who birthed stars, was pleased …" becomes two statements: "The mother of the cosmos *is* the first light that gave birth to the stars; she was glad when she heard …". ka (by nature, no tense) makes the identity timeless. "Pleased to hear" becomes "glad when she heard": ADJ + sidu would make her the thing heard.
16	*one by one, star by star, further*	rada-krono, baba loterosan	No word	No distributive idiom: "each time, another point of shimmering light was brought forth". The doubling and its rhythm are lost.
17	*repeatedly*	sahi	Approximate	Habitual aspect: "to sing habitually". reve (again) would mean one repetition.
18	*musical note*	melosan sonbu	No word	No word for a musical note (mambicuza is a written note): "a musical sound".
19	*wielded*	bitiba	Approximate	"To use (a tool)": loses the force of "wield".
20	*veena*	veena	No word	No Liraasa word. Copied as a foreign name, which the spelling allows exactly (ve-E-na). lansimelobiti (harp) is the nearest native word if a native term is preferred.
21	*pluck · plucked*	dalu · daluda	No word	No verb "pluck": dalu (touch) / daluda (to touch). "Each pluck of her tool" becomes "each touch of the string" (melotibi, an instrument string), avoiding a two-de chain.
22	*heat*	suma	Approximate	Translated as written: suma, warmth. If "heat" is a typing slip for "heart", the word is lore (… li lore de li veluri …).
23	*concert · her play*	melo · saivo de meloasa	No word	No word for "concert" (melopago is a concert hall): "her unending music". "To hear her play" becomes "to hear her divine music".
24	*as*	kasa	Approximate	English "as" can mean "because" or "while"; kasa (because) is chosen. nayo would give "while".
25	*synonymous with*	sambasan ko	No word	"The same as": no word for synonymy.
26	*civilizations*	mavopagori	Approximate	"Societies." (mavopagoasa, the ascended form, means Heaven, so it cannot be used here.)
27	*knew of her existence*	sabesia saivo	Approximate	

				“Knew her.” saivo de pagoasa would mean “her universe”, not “her existence”, so the existence is folded into knowing her.
28	*implication*	lideodonu	No word	“Suggestion.” No word for logical implication.
29	*philosophers · thinkers*	lideoserbuyori · pensayori	Approximate	Built by the productive -yo rule (philosophy → philosopher; thought → thinker). Correct by rule but not listed: confirm for 3.0.
30	*attuned*	yebasan	No word	“In accord.” No word for attunement.
31	*debate*	senoralkasia	Approximate	“To argue, to quarrel.” Less formal than “debate”.
32	*to this day*	loki … eli-krono	Approximate	“Still … now.” “To this day” needs tuni + a time noun phrase, and no noun “this day” exists.
33	*tap (feet)*	dumdoda	No word	“To drum, to beat.” No verb “tap”.
34	*in accordance with*	gase	Approximate	“Like, along with.”
35	*greatest*	mosa sirmosan	Approximate	“Most famous.” No general adjective “great” in this sense (mellisan, large, is used for the “great worlds”).
36	*theologians*	sabeyori de li devo	No word	“Sages of faith.” No word for theology.
37	*to music*	en li melo	Approximate	“Lose themselves *in* music”: ala (toward) cannot carry surrender.
38	*and so it was, and so it is, and so it shall be*	ola … ka vera	No word	The liturgical “so it was / is / shall be” has no form: a copula always needs a predicate. Rendered “that was true, and that is true, and that will be true”, using ka for what holds by nature.
39	*by (authorship)*	da	Approximate	gagu (by) marks only the agent of a passive verb, so authorship becomes da, “from the first mother”. The whole line is a verbless dedication, as in English.